

17. Jn. 12:6 *εμελεν* || *εμελλεν* [60%] [taking account of the corrections, the MSS I have collated (57) are about evenly divided. Is the verb *μελω* or *μελλω*? *μελει* as an impersonal form is most common; however the verb is also used in a personal/active sense. *μελλω* (‘to be about to’) does not make sense here. *μελλω* is about ten times as frequent in the NT and some copyists may have put the more customary spelling without thinking. They had just written *μελλων* two lines above and may have repeated the form by attraction. However, since both forms have the same pronunciation, someone hearing the Text read aloud would understand it correctly, being guided by the context. Precisely for this reason, it may be that the semantic area of the longer form came to be regarded as including that of the shorter form; in which case we would have alternate spellings of the same verb. (It is not my custom to appeal to the early uncials, but all of them have the shorter form here, which would go along with my hypothesis above.) The first hand of 2554 left space for the second *lambda*, so he was aware of the variant, but he correctly did not copy it.]

18. Jn. 12:40 *ιασωμαι* || *ιασομαι* [20%] 2554 [the first hand of 2554 left space to complete the *omega*, so he was aware of the variant; within the context the change in tense does not affect the meaning]

Comment: I consider that the first hand has two proper variants in John, and they do not affect the meaning. $2 + 4 + 1 = 7$; a manuscript with only seven variants for all four Gospels is surely a paragon of virtue. I call that extraordinarily careful transmission, since it would also be true of the preceding generations, of necessity.

19. Acts 1:11 *ουτος* || *1 ο* [70%] 2554 [a demonstrative pronoun defines, even more than a definite article, so the article is redundant here; in any case, the meaning is not affected]

20. Acts 11:26 *συναχθηναι* || *1 εν* [20%] 2554 [the family is divided here, a bare majority of the 35 MSS that I have collated add the preposition, that is a ‘natural’ but is redundant; in any case, the meaning is not affected]

21. Acts 12:25 *εις αντιοχειαν* || *απο ιερουσαλημ* 2554 [this is the only place in the whole NT where Family 35 splinters, there being a six-way split (usually there are only two main contenders); for a detailed discussion please see my article, “Where to place a comma—Acts 12:25”, available from my site, www.prunch.org; within the context, the two readings given here have the same effect; the article is also the last item in the Appendix of my translation of the N.T., *The*